



Partnership for Better Health Strategic Plan

Project Overview

The Partnership for Better Health, a nonprofit community foundation established in 2001, is seeking a strategic impact consultant and thought partner to guide a refresh of its current strategic plan. Our understanding is that the foundation aims to build on past momentum and identify the next steps to fulfill its existing goals—centering equity and inclusion in its policies, investments, and health solutions—by engaging a partner with deep expertise in nonprofit strategic planning, community health, and grassroots engagement. Our proposal outlines a collaborative process designed to leverage this expertise, working with your board and staff to craft a forward-looking plan with measurable goals that are grounded in the community's needs.

About Project Solved

Project Solved is an organizational change management consulting firm based in Wilmington, Delaware, with over 20 years of combined experience serving nonprofits, community organizations, and public agencies. Our mission is to help leaders move from vision to execution by building stronger teams, aligning culture, and designing strategies that achieve lasting impact. We specialize in nonprofit capacity building, strategic planning, and stakeholder engagement, with deep expertise in healthcare, diversity and inclusion, and grassroots community outreach.

Relevant Project Experience

Our team has engaged in community work for more than two decades, partnering with organizations at the intersection of public health, equity, and community development. We have facilitated cross-sector initiatives, supported inclusive engagement processes, and helped boards and leadership teams translate community priorities into actionable strategies.

Client / Engagement	Scope of Work	Key Contributions & Outcomes
Pennsylvania Legislative Black Caucus – Strategic Planning & Organizational Launch	Supported the launch of a newly established board and organization through comprehensive strategic planning.	- Facilitated development of a collaborative strategic plan aligning mission, vision, and emerging programs. - Designed and led team development sessions using DiSC® to build shared leadership culture. - Supported governance design, resource planning, and long-term capacity-building strategies.
Spur Impact – Nonprofit Strategic Planning	Guided strategic planning to strengthen infrastructure and position the nonprofit for growth.	- Facilitated sessions with staff, board, and stakeholders to ensure alignment. - Clarified mission and vision, aligning programming with community needs. - Delivered a plan with measurable goals and tangible strategies for growth and sustainability.
State of Delaware Department of Health and Social Services – Organizational Strategy & Change Management	Led strategy and change management to establish a mission-critical specialist unit supporting statewide service modernization.	- Spearheaded strategy and launch of new specialist unit for staff professional development. - Conducted research, community input sessions, and implementation planning for citizen-centric service models. - Designed a Train-the-Trainer program and delivered coaching for frontline staff to drive adoption of new service delivery models.

Why Project Solved

Our strategic planning approach is designed to be highly collaborative, inclusive, and centered on the people and communities the Partnership for Better Health serves. We specialize in guiding groups through strategic planning exercises that ensure all voices are heard and all stakeholders have the opportunity to help lay the groundwork for organizational mission, strategy, and tactics. We are comfortable navigating complex conversations and group dynamics to move strategy forward while ensuring participants feel valued and engaged.

Our methodology is grounded in key principles:

- **Core Expertise and Focus:** We begin with deep healthcare and equity expertise, ensuring the plan fundamentally integrates health outcomes, diversity, inclusion, and lived experience. Our proven track record with nonprofits allows us to expertly balance board priorities, staff capacity, and authentic community voices. We also actively cultivate cross-sector collaboration, forging new partnerships that catalyze progress toward key organizational goals.
- **Equity-First Engagement:** Our process is inherently Centered on Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Access (DEIA), acting as a lens to prevent systemic racism or implicit bias from impeding progress. We use specialized community engagement skills to create inclusive, generative spaces that uplift the voices of historically disadvantaged communities. We ensure that the communities we seek to serve are actively included in the planning, ideation, creation, and approval of the strategy.
- **Sustainable Results:** The execution phase is guided by our proven framework for sustainability (Assess → Decide → Do → Sustain), moving the plan beyond ideas into measurable results. As a data-driven firm, we seamlessly integrate data and analytics throughout the project to measure efficacy, prove the impact of initiatives, and provide a clear baseline for continuous improvement.

Project Solved is uniquely well-qualified to guide the Partnership for Better Health's strategic plan refresh as culturally responsive evaluators, expert facilitators, and human-centered designers with documented experience in organizational change management for nonprofits. Our firm's qualifications directly meet the Partnership's requirements and goals:

- **Deep Expertise in Strategic Planning, Community Health, and Philanthropy:** We possess the required proven knowledge of strategic planning for nonprofit organizations, community health, and philanthropy. Our consultants have extensive experience leading strategy development, managing large-scale strategy evaluations, and working in public health and federal service, including for major philanthropic organizations.
- **Commitment to Equity and Inclusion:** Our team is dedicated to an equity-first approach, which directly supports the Foundation's Goals 1 and 2 (Create equitable policies/practices; Build equitable investment processes). The project team specializes in equity-centered measurement and culturally responsive evaluation, ensuring that justice, health equity, diversity, inclusion, and belonging are integrated into the refresh process.
- **Centering People with Lived Experience (PWLE):** We have the experience needed to address Goal 3 by focusing on stakeholder engagement and using data-driven, story-based strategies to integrate the voices of PWLE in building community health solutions.
- **Development of Aspirational and Measurable Plans:** We are experts in crafting multi-year strategic plans with measurable goals and objectives. Our strengths include quantitative and mixed-methods design, longitudinal performance tracking, and the development of indicators and dashboards to create a practical, forward-looking strategy. This ensures we deliver the required aspirational and measurable strategic plan.

Our Motivation And Expected Impact

Project Solved is particularly interested in this project due to our proven experience in strategic planning for nonprofits and our expertise in community health and philanthropy. We have a depth of experience in grassroots community engagement, consensus building, and developing aspirational and measurable strategic plans. Our experience in centering people with lived experience (PWLE) in our work is also a key differentiator and a plus for the Partnership's goals.

What will be achieved: The ultimate achievement will be a polished, actionable strategic plan document that articulates the Partnership's role, focus areas, and a clear roadmap for the next several years.

Proposed Strategies

Our approach is an equitable and iterative process designed to be highly collaborative, inclusive, and centered on the people and communities the Partnership serves.

The refresh will be executed through a four-phase workflow:

- 1. Phase 1: Discovery & Align on Process Goals (November 2025):** We will establish a comprehensive understanding of the current state through document review (including community health needs assessments) and leadership interviews to align on goals and identify all key stakeholders.
- 2. Phase 2: Internal Assessment & Stakeholder Engagement (December 2025 - January 2026):** We will actively solicit input from the board, staff, volunteers, and key partners through surveys, strategic partner interviews, and focus groups with key community stakeholders. All findings will be merged into a SCOT (Strengths, Challenges, Opportunities, Threats) Analysis.
- 3. Phase 3: Strategy Development & Refinement (February - March 2026):** We will facilitate an in-person Strategic Planning Session with all staff and leadership to present the SCOT analysis, prioritize core opportunities, and identify SMART goals and strategies. This phase includes drafting, internal review, and gathering feedback to develop the final plan.
- 4. Phase 4: Finalization & Handoff (Late March 2026):** We will present the final strategic plan and provide comprehensive handoff materials to ensure a smooth transition and clear understanding of next steps.

Project Management Methods

We will utilize a structured, yet flexible, methodology grounded in organizational change management principles.

Key project management methods include:

- **Iterative Process:** The proposed workflow is iterative, ensuring opportunities for feedback and refinement at the end of each phase before moving to the next.
- **Structured Deliverables:** Each phase concludes with defined deliverables (e.g., Updated Work Plan, SCOT Analysis, Draft Plan) to maintain accountability and track progress against the timeline.
- **Consensus Building:** We specialize in guiding groups through strategic planning exercises that ensure all voices are heard, utilizing structured facilitation techniques to navigate complex conversations and build consensus.

How Your Values Will Be Incorporated

Your values, which we understand to center around justice, health equity, diversity, inclusion, and belonging, will be integrated as a core lens throughout our entire strategic planning process.

- **Equity-First Approach:** Our team is dedicated to an equity-first approach, ensuring that systemic racism, implicit bias, and inauthentic engagement do not impede progress.
- **Centered on DEIA:** Our projects are completed with a DEIA lens. We will co-create generative spaces where all cultures, languages, and lived experiences are respected, ensuring communities are actively included in planning, ideation, and creation.
- **Centering PWLE:** We directly address the value of centering people with lived experience by focusing on targeted stakeholder engagement and using data-driven, story-based strategies to integrate their voices.

Final Plan And Measurability

The refreshed strategic plan for the Partnership for Better Health will be designed as a multi-year, living document that is both strategically aspirational and operationally measurable. To ensure accountability and learning over time, the plan will be structured around clearly defined goals, measurable objectives, and multi-year indicators that align with the foundation's mission to champion equitable health in the region.

The final deliverables will include:

- A polished strategic plan organized into clear focus areas (e.g., Impact, Scale, Sustainability, or People, Operations, Programs).
- SMART goals (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) for each strategic goal.
- Dashboards and indicators to track progress longitudinally.
- Accountability measures to ensure continuous alignment with equity principles.
- A PowerPoint deck summarizing key elements of the plan for board, partner, and community presentations.

The following proposed work plan and evaluation matrix reflects our current understanding of the project. We are open to adjustments and changes as needed.

	Strategic Goal	Evaluation Questions	Key Indicators / Metrics	Potential Data Sources	Analytic Plan	Timeline
	Goal 1: Create equitable and inclusive organizational policies and practices	To what extent has the organization adopted and implemented equity-driven internal policies and practices?	• #/% of policies revised with equity lens • Staff & board survey results on DEIB climate • Representation of diverse voices in decision-making	HR and policy records, staff & board surveys, meeting minutes	Content analysis of policy language, pre/post climate surveys, equity audit comparison	Annual review with 3-year summary
		How are staff and board members experiencing belonging and inclusion?	• Belonging and inclusion scores • Staff/board retention by demographic	Employee engagement surveys, exit interviews, HR data	Quantitative trend analysis; thematic coding of qualitative feedback	Annual
	Goal 2A: Build equitable and inclusive community investment process (Grants & Initiatives)	How equitable and transparent is the grantmaking process?	• #/% of applicants/grantees from historically underrepresented groups • Grant approval rates disaggregated by demographics • Applicant feedback on transparency	Grantmaking database, applicant feedback surveys, demographic data	Equity audit of grantee pool; statistical comparison across groups	Annual with 3-year cumulative
		To what extent do funded initiatives address community-identified priorities?	• Alignment of funded projects with CHNA/community needs • % of grants co-designed with community partners	Grant applications, CHNA data, community partner interviews	Alignment mapping; qualitative coding of proposals	Annual
	Goal 2B: Build equitable and inclusive community investment process (Community Engagement, Partnerships & Policy Advocacy)	How is the foundation engaging community partners in decision-making?	• #/% of initiatives co-led with partners • Network analysis of partnerships • PWLE representation in advisory bodies	Partnership MOUs, meeting rosters, engagement logs	Network mapping; equity representation analysis	Biannual
		What policy and systems changes are advanced through advocacy efforts?	• # of advocacy campaigns supported • Documented policy wins or shifts influenced	Advocacy reports, legislative tracking, partner testimonials	Contribution analysis; case study methods	Annual
	Goal 3: Center People with Lived Experience (PWLE) in building community health solutions	To what extent are PWLE engaged as co-creators of solutions?	• #/% of PWLE in advisory or leadership roles • Compensation provided to PWLE for participation	Board/committee rosters, compensation records	Equity tracking; participatory evaluation methods	Annual
		How are community health outcomes improving in areas identified by PWLE?	• Community-level health indicators (disaggregated) • Perceptions of empowerment from PWLE	Public health datasets (CHNA, county health rankings), focus groups with PWLE	Mixed-methods (trend analysis + narrative coding)	Multi-year tracking (every 2–3 years)

Beyond delivering the final document, Project Solved is prepared to offer ongoing strategic plan implementation support (post-March 2026). Our core business is organizational change management, with specialties in designing solutions and implementation. We can assist the Partnership by:

- Providing support in developing and launching new programs and workflows needed to operationalize the strategies.
- Assisting in the execution of the timeline and delegation plan for each strategy, ensuring momentum is maintained long after the planning phase is complete.

Budget Table

Scope Element	Total Cost
Discovery & Align on Process Goals	\$1,500
Internal Assessment & Stakeholder Engagement (Includes SCOT Analysis)	\$3,500
Strategy Development & Refinement (Includes In-person planning session)	\$3,500
Finalization & Hand-off	\$1,500
Graphic Design (Optional)	
Totals	\$10,000

BIOGRAPHIES

Kristen Scott, MPH.

Kristen Scott is a change management consultant, facilitator, and strategist with over 15 years' experience spanning healthcare, public health, nonprofit leadership, and organizational development. She is the Founder and CEO of Project Solved, a Wilmington, Delaware-based consulting firm specializing in team dynamics, strategic planning, and equity-centered change management. Kristen holds a Bachelor of Science from Howard University and a Master of Public Health from Thomas Jefferson University. She also earned a Diversity and Inclusion Certificate from Cornell University, a Strategic Change Management Certificate from Northwestern University's Kellogg School of Management and is certified in DiSC® and The Five Behaviors of a Cohesive Team®. Her portfolio includes:

- Founder & CEO, Project Solved: Led strategic planning, organizational change, and leadership development engagements for nonprofits, small to mid-sized businesses, and governmental agencies.
- Healthcare & Public Health Initiatives: Directed programs and partnerships to improve efficiency, resource utilization, and equity within health and human services organizations. Developed and implemented workflows, workforce development programs, and employee resource groups focused on inclusion and belonging.
- Leadership & Program Development: Built and scaled leadership pipelines, team alignment initiatives, and board development programs, including the launch of a nonprofit board leadership program that has prepared more than 40 leaders for service.
- Community Engagement & Outreach: Designed stakeholder engagement strategies, facilitated cross-sector collaborations, and created communication approaches to ensure that lived experience and community priorities inform strategic decision-making.

Relevant strengths for this engagement: nonprofit strategic planning, healthcare and community health knowledge, diversity/equity/inclusion expertise, facilitation of cross-sector and community engagement processes, and development of actionable, measurable roadmaps that support long-term sustainability.

Christopher D. Hill, Ph.D.

Dr. Hill is a research psychologist, statistician, and evaluator with 15+ years' experience spanning federal service, philanthropy, higher education, and independent consulting. He has led or advised large-scale, equity-centered measurement and evaluation initiatives, including:

- Senior Program Officer (Measurement, Learning & Evaluation), Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation: Designed and led equity-minded measurement and strategic learning for Postsecondary Success; managed strategy-level evaluation portfolios and performance assessment.
- Statistician/Project Manager & Data Quality Strategy Lead, NCES (CRDC): Directed day-to-day operations for a national data collection; led data quality strategy; coordinated OMB clearances and disclosure review; developed cross-agency data sharing agreements.
- U.S. Department of Education, Office of Migrant Education: Data & evaluation team lead for formula and discretionary grant programs; developed reports to Congress; built technical assistance and data governance routines.

- Public health evaluation experience via CMMI (HHS) and statewide equity initiatives at Loyola Marymount University's Psychology Applied Research Center (multi-population, multi-grantee evaluation, TA, IRB, data warehousing).
- Independent consulting: External evaluator (NSF HBCU-UP), lead data consultant (Association of Black Psychologists—Black Mental Health Workforce Survey), and strategic partner to community-based organizations.

Relevant strengths for this engagement: quantitative and mixed-methods design; data quality strategy and governance; data collection for large-scale federal programs; longitudinal performance tracking; cost-benefit analysis; and indicator and dashboard development (e.g., Tableau). Possesses a proven knowledge of strategic planning, evaluation, and equity-centered work in philanthropy and public health, supporting the need for a measurable and justice-focused plan

David J. Hanson, Ph.D.

Dr. Hanson is an evaluation consultant and strategist specializing in culturally responsive and equitable evaluation, stakeholder engagement, and qualitative/mixed methods designs. His portfolio includes:

- Director of Evaluation and Social Equity, Cause IMPACTS: Designed evaluation frameworks and data-driven, story-based strategies for social impact across diverse stakeholders. Clients included REDF, the Hilton Foundation, and San Francisco Safe Routes to School.
- Senior Consultant, Social Contract: Managed projects in environmental justice, health equity evaluations, community violence interventions, and DEIA assessments for state and local agencies (e.g., RI Department of Health, DE Department of Health and Social Services, Allegheny County DHS).
- Senior Consultant, Equal Measure: National/regional engagements including the BUILD Health Challenge; designed and implemented focus groups, interviews, and surveys; analyzed qualitative and quantitative data.
- Evaluation Coordinator, UF/IFAS Family Nutrition Program: Program evaluation, database administration, evaluation instrument design, and statewide reporting for a public-health nutrition initiative.

Relevant strengths for this engagement: culturally responsive and equitable evaluation; stakeholder engagement; qualitative and mixed-methods design; qualitative instrument development (interviews/focus groups); thematic analysis (NVivo/R); and plain-language reporting for diverse audiences. Excels in the qualitative, community-focused, and equity aspects of the RFP, including stakeholder engagement and centering people with lived experience (PWLE).